not appointed as the Delhi police commissioner. Someone two years my junior was elevated to this post. The announcement of this posting was deliberately pushed to past bedtime for most people so as to effectively kill the news.

My self-respect, my innate sense of justice and my beliefs and values in life propelled me to throw off the 'yokes' that were already obstructing my growth and I now made up my mind to set myself free and be a master of my own time.

In other words, I decided to move on. Along with my moving on (quitting government service) moved out all the trappings. I shifted out of my government-allotted and maintained bungalow with a front lawn the size of a tennis court and a carefully cultivated vegetable garden behind. The house was located in Lutyens' Delhi (named after the famous British architect Sir Edwin Lutyens) and had staff quarters as well. It was just a few metres away from the Presidential Estate and shared a boundary wall with one of Delhi's best maintained public parks called the Talkatora Gardens. Here my mother and I went for walks, sometimes even twice a day. I also bid goodbye to a chauffeur-driven car and all the telephone connections.

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After my opting for early retirement (when I still had two years' service left), I have been repeatedly asked how would I have policed the city if I were the police commissioner, particularly when we have serious security concerns.

I have kept on saying that I would have had no choice but to have gone all out, on all fronts, for achieving holistic and substantial results. The city required a paradigm shift in the manner it was being policed. Nothing could wait. Be it *crime prevention strategies, *the quality and the processes of crime investigation and detection, *law and order management, *terrorism prevention through maximum intelligence, *rebuilding public trust in the police, *providing better training or *overhauling traffic management and ensuring road safety with tough enforcement of laws.

I would have addressed hitherto totally neglected areas such as: *police welfare, *grooming of leadership, *putting in place proper management practices and human resource policies, *systems building and *oversight mechanisms, through heightened internal vigilance and external co-opting of civil society, including the academia, and opening the police for research.

Most of all, I would have led by example. I would have worked harder, and in a more effective manner, than I would have expected of others.

Delhi Police would have become an ideal organization in which much could be learnt, not only by the newcomers but also by the seniors.

I would have started by calling for brainstorming sessions/ workshops with the ranks that are the closest to the ground (i.e., caught up in the nitty-gritty of police work) but not a part of any policy making. The system being very rigidly hierarchical, such ranks merely receive orders to be implemented without their views and opinions being heard. If change has to be brought about, it would have to begin by co-opting the rank and file and making them full-fledged stakeholders. Implementation of decisions taken during the interaction of the seniors with those at the lower levels would then become qualitatively different. Such a policy change has not taken place in Indian governance yet. I have personally lived and practised this and seen the positive results, at the district level, be it crime prevention and detection, law and order, traffic, police training, prison management or general administration.

The brainstorming sessions would naturally come up with action-oriented and practical strategies for ensuring that the goods are delivered. Moreover, *tasks and goals would get set for all, *regular